



Jersey City Bitcoin Socratic Seminar #4

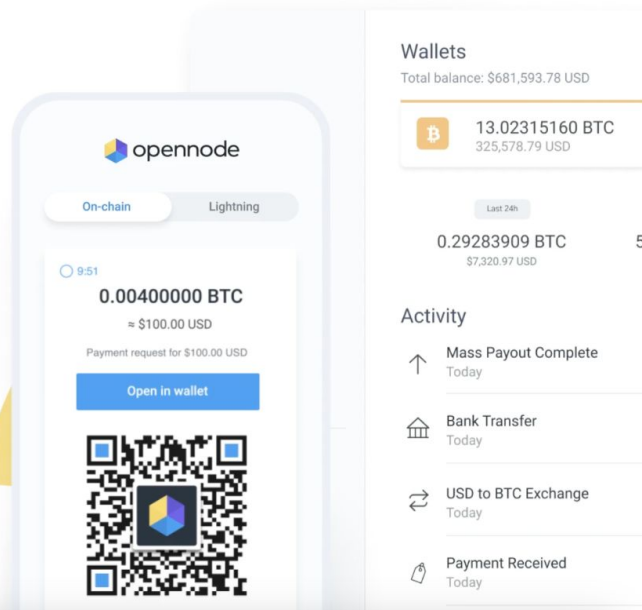
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Bitcoin payments at the speed of now

Get lightning-fast, low-cost bitcoin payments and payouts for your business with our powerful API, ecommerce plugins, or hosted payment pages.



Agenda:

- Intro
- Book Sharing Program
- Bitcoin Price Update
- Macro Update
- Podcast Spotlight
- Bitcoin History
- BIP 110
- BIP 360
- Freedom Tech Spotlight
- Meme of the Month
- Club Direction and 2026 Goals



JC Bitcoin Meetup General Guidelines

- Basic Rules:

- Please no photos, no videos, no public tagging without consent!
- This group is Bitcoin only so please limit discussion of other cryptocurrencies.
- PLEASE respect the space. We love the barrow mansion and ask for help making it look better than when we arrived.
- For newcomers and OGs alike it is worth reiterating that absolutely no one from JC Bitcoin will ever solicit Bitcoin or crypto transfers here or on any other channel

Number Time

Clark Moody Bitcoin			Dashboard		
Markets ?			Blockchain ?		
Price	\$68,660		Block Height	936,815	
Sats per Dollar	1,456		UTX0 Set Size	164,297,540	
Market Capitalization	\$1.37T		Block Time, Prior Year	9:57	
Drop some sats in the Tip Jar			Chain Size	820.9 GB	
			OP_RETURN Data	0.0 GB	
All-Time High ?			Bitcoin Network ?		
All-Time High Price	\$126,160		Reachable Bitcoin Nodes	25,241	
Decline from ATH	-45.60%		Bitcoin Tor Nodes	16,484	
ATH Date	October 6, 2025		Percentage Tor Nodes	65.31%	
Days Since ATH	132		Lightning Network (Public) ?		
Gold ?			Total Capacity	4,997.61 BTC	
Bitcoin priced in Gold	16.3 oz		Capacity Value	\$343.1M	
Bitcoin vs Gold Market Cap	4.59%		Total Nodes	9,949	
Corporate Treasuries ?			Total Channels	39,262	
Held in Corp. Treasuries	2,285,604 BTC		Tor Capacity	3,972.52 BTC	
Value in Corp. Treasuries	\$156.9B		Percentage Tor Capacity	79.5%	
Supply Pct. in Corp. Treasuries	11.43%		Tor Nodes	5,386	
Supply ?			Bitfinex Lightning Node ?		
Money Supply	19,989,819.91 BTC		Inbound Capacity	233.48 BTC	
Percentage Issued	95.19%		Outbound Capacity	857.30 BTC	
Unspendable	230.09 BTC		Bitfinex Channels	560	
Issuance Remaining	1,009,949.98 BTC		Liquid Sidechain ?		
			Peg-in Capacity	-96.06 BTC	
			Peg-in Capacity Value	\$-6,595,191.89	
			Liquid Block Height	3,758,944	
			Liquid Chain Size	52.0 GB	
			Transactions ?		
			Total All Time	1,310,843,708	
			Rate, 30 days	4.8 tx/s	
			Count, 30 days	12,742,529	
			Chain Security ?		
			Hash Rate, 90 Days	1,020.0 EH/s	
			Chain Work	96.0 bits	
			Chain Rewrite Days	896	
			Annual Mining Revenue	\$16.6B	
			Mining ?		
			Hash Rate, 2016 Blocks	1,023.2 EH/s	
			Difficulty	125.9x10 ¹²	
			Difficulty Epoch	465	
			Last Difficulty Change	-11.2%	
			Block Time, 2016 Blocks	9:09	
			Difficulty Retarget ?		
			Blocks to Retarget	625	
			Retarget Date	February 19, 2026	
			Estimated Difficulty Change	14.9%	
			Block Time, Diff. Epoch	8:42	
			Mining Economics ?		
			Block Subsidy	3.13 BTC	
			Block Subsidy Value	\$214,563	
			Daily PHash/s Revenue	48,374 sats	
			Daily PHash/s Value	\$33.67	
			Avg. Fees per Block	0.02 BTC	
			Avg. Fees vs. Reward	0.64%	

Quick Mempool Check





Explore the full Bitcoin ecosystem

~0 sat/vB
0.12 - 0.12 sat/vB
1 BTC
72 transactions
In ~34 minutes

~0 sat/vB
0.12 - 0.12 sat/vB
0.001 BTC
72 transactions
In ~26 minutes

~0 sat/vB
0.12 - 0.14 sat/vB
0.001 BTC
2,663 transactions
In ~17 minutes

~0 sat/vB
0.14 - 403 sat/vB
0.009 BTC
4,656 transactions
In ~8 minutes

TRANSACTION FEES

No Priority	Low Priority	Medium Priority	High Priority
0.1 sat/vB \$0.01	0.1 sat/vB \$0.01	0.5 sat/vB \$0.05	1 sat/vB \$0.10

936815
~1 sat/vB
0.13 - 244 sat/vB
0.019 BTC
3,635 transactions
7 minutes ago
MARA Pool

936814
~0 sat/vB
0.10 - 5.00 sat/vB
0.00 BTC
2,373 transactions
27 minutes ago
SECPool

936813
~0 sat/vB
0.12 - 224 sat/vB
0.009 BTC
1,887 transactions
27 minutes ago
MARA Pool

936812
~1 sat/vB
0.13 - 212 sat/vB
0.012 BTC
2,879 transactions
33 minutes ago
AntPool

DIFFICULTY ADJUSTMENT

difficulty halving

~8.7 minutes
Average block time

▲ 14.93 %
Previous: ▼ 11.16 %

In ~3 days
February 19 at 1:31 PM

Jersey City Bitcoin Education Center Library & Book Sharing Program

- Bring bitcoin books you have already read and exchange for ones you haven't! Trade back the following month.
- Borrow books from current library with Sats deposit. Return next month and receive your deposit back.
- Konsensus Network provides discounts on book purchases from Bitcoin Communities. This should be available soon.

Bitcoin Price Update:



LAST Month's Bitcoin Price Update:

- Flat price
- We
- No move in options expiry though
- Gold price could now be a strong support

- *Bull trap or new floor?*
 - (Bull trap confirmed)



Bitcoin Price Update:

- [Jeff Park's Thesis Summary](#)
- TLDR:
 - On February 5, Bitcoin fell sharply (~13%), during one of the most extreme risk-off events in broader capital markets.
- Yet despite the crash:
 - There were net ETF inflows, not outflows.
 - IBIT actually had net creations (~\$230M+), with broader ETF inflows around \$300M+.
- A TradFi-driven forced deleveraging event that triggered derivative hedging cascades, not a crypto fundamental breakdown



Jeff Park

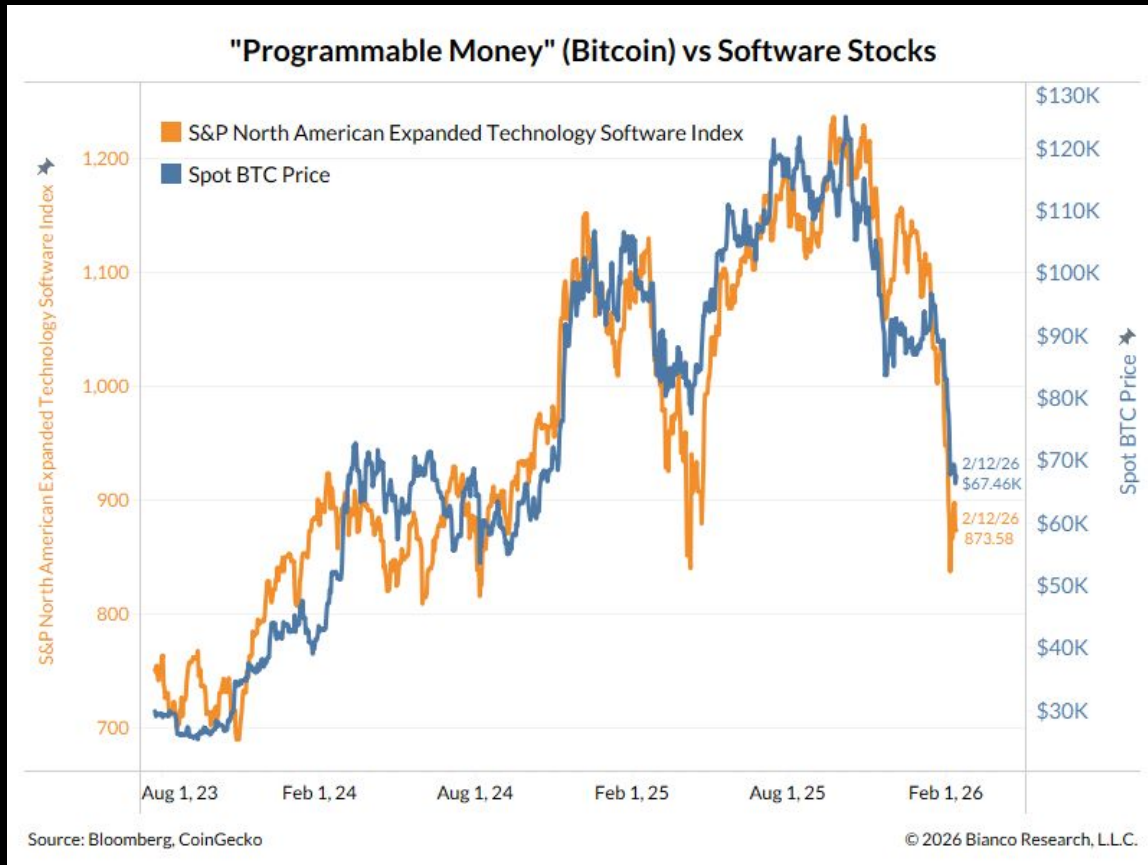
@dgt10011



So what happened on 2/5?

Bitcoin Price Update:

- Bitcoin is correlated not just to risk assets, but software specifically
- Market panic due to Ai moment caused a cascade
- Either the market is right, or there's a serious opportunity to take advantage of this mispricing
- Nasdaq and S&P also flat since October

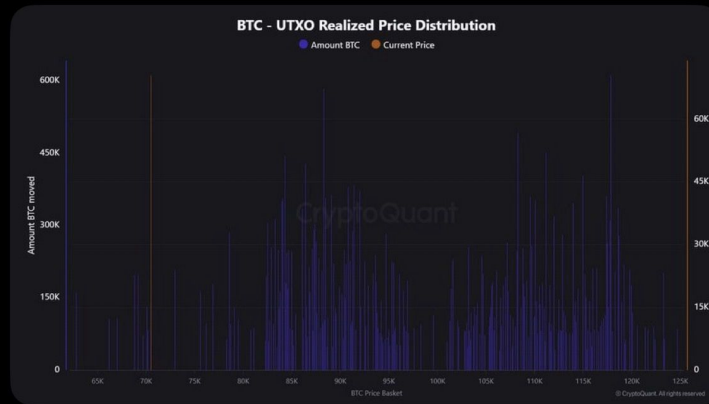




Bitcoin News 🌟
@BitcoinNewsCom

X.com

Bitcoin accumulation addresses are acquiring around 372,000 BTC per month, 37x more from the 10,000 BTC per month in September 2024.



11:28 · 2/17/26 · 1K Views

Macro Update

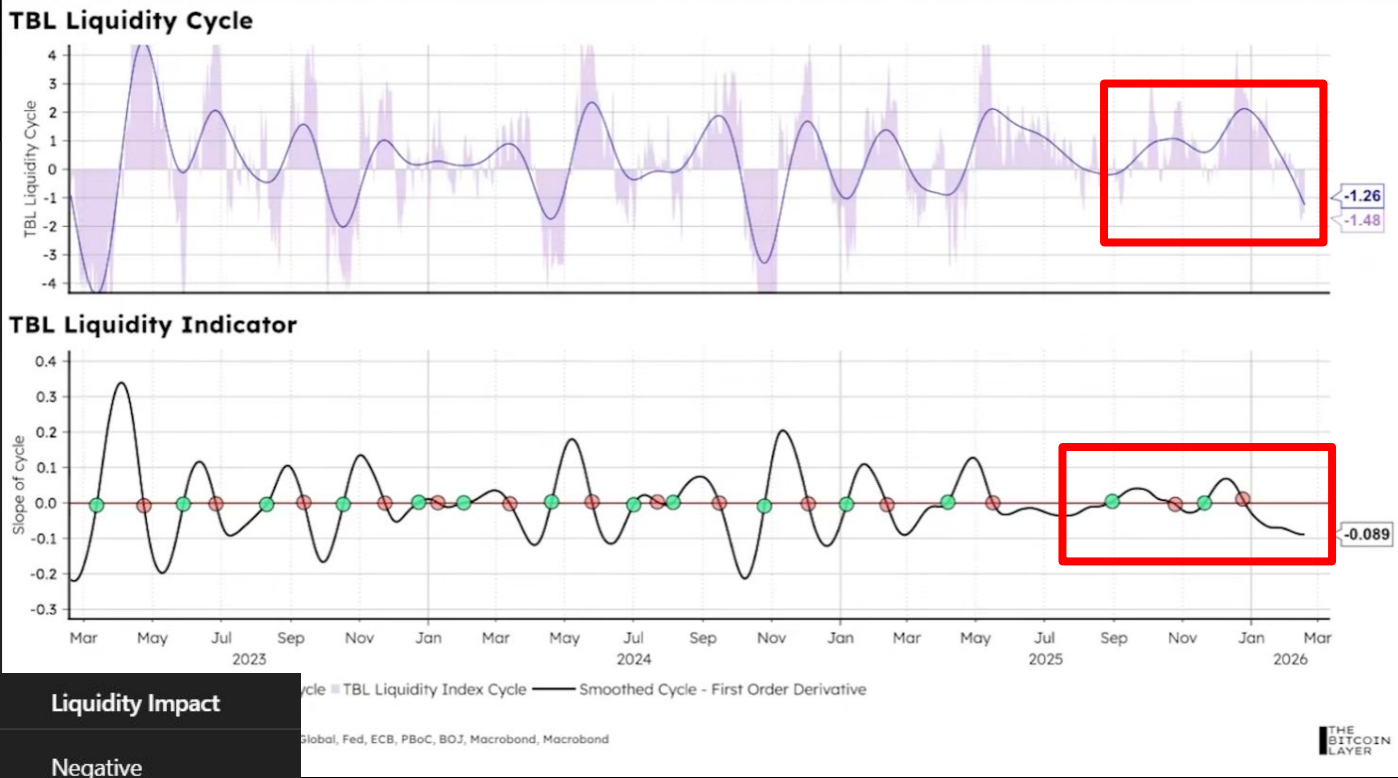
Short-Term (Now)

- Liquidity impulse negative
- Dollar volatility high
- Bond volatility elevated
- Risk assets unstable
- Bitcoin in liquidity-driven drawdown

Medium-Term (2026 Outlook)

- Bank credit expanding
- Early economic cycle dynamics
- Inflation possibly contained
- Potential rate cuts
- Structural liquidity expansion still plausible

Factor	Direction	Liquidity Impact
Dollar	↑	Negative
Bond Volatility	↑	Negative
Banking Assets	Expanding	Positive (longer-term)
CPI	Falling toward low 2s	Positive (if stable)



Why are we here?



ODELL
@ODELL

...

It's easy to get lost in the price movements and lose sight of the mission

If bitcoin fails we are all fucked, governments and corporations would have complete and total control of money with the ability to track, seize, and censor at will.

It is that simple. Life is short and there is no mission I would rather be focused on.

All in, no regrets.

Podcast Spotlight



Meetups are the Ultimate Web of Trust: Jersey City, NJ | Ep. 002



Local Bitcoiners

Episode · Feb 16 · 1h 21m

“These webs of trust that we’re building, all of us, right now, right before Ai fundamentally undermines our ability to trust anything online, these friendships, the networking of like minded people, this is going to be the only way to move forward with bitcoin”

- GC

Bitcoin History - Mt. Gox

- Mt. Gox is one of the most important chapters in Bitcoin's history, a cautionary tale which *coined* the phrase:
- **Not your keys, not your coins**

Not your



Not your



Bitcoin History - Mt. Gox

- 2007 – The domain mtgox.com was created by Jed McCaleb as “Magic: The Gathering Online eXchange,” a trading site for game cards.
- July 2010 – McCaleb repurposed the site into a Bitcoin exchange.
- Early 2011 – Mt. Gox quickly became the dominant place to trade Bitcoin.
- By 2013, Mt. Gox handled roughly 70% of all Bitcoin trading volume worldwide.



Bitcoin History - Mt. Gox

- 2013: The Bubble and Hidden Insolvency
 - April 2013 – Bitcoin surges above \$260, then crashes.
 - November 2013 – Bitcoin hits ~\$1,100 (on some exchanges).
- Behind the scenes:
 - Mt. Gox had already been losing Bitcoin for years.
 - The company blamed “transaction malleability” for withdrawal issues.
 - In reality, the exchange had terrible accounting and security practices.



Bitcoin History - Mt. Gox

- **February 2014: Collapse!**
 - Feb 7, 2014 – Mt. Gox halts Bitcoin withdrawals.
 - Feb 24, 2014 – Website goes offline.
 - Feb 28, 2014 – Mt. Gox files for bankruptcy protection in Japan.
- **The Numbers**
 - 850,000 BTC reported missing
 - At the time: ~\$450 million
 - At today's values: tens of billions
- This was one of the largest financial collapses in crypto history.
- It was a massive moment in the history of Bitcoin. Many people didn't think it would survive afterwards. The price went from over \$1,000 to under \$200



Bitcoin History - Mt. Gox

What Actually Happened?

- Mt. Gox was not “hacked once.”
- It was slowly drained over years.
- Poor security practices, hot wallet exposure, bad accounting, and internal mismanagement allowed attackers to siphon Bitcoin continuously.
- Bitcoin itself was never compromised.

Mt. Gox shaped Bitcoin culture permanently:

- “Not your keys, not your coins”
- Rise of hardware wallets
- Emphasis on self-custody
- Development of better exchange proof-of-reserve practices
- Growth of decentralized custody solutions

It was a painful but necessary lesson, which has fallen off quite a bit with the popularity of the ETF's and financial products

Bip 110

- I decided I really don't want to talk about this, but here's something funny
- The thing is, the soft fork is commencing and thousands of nodes are running it
- At block height 961,632
- Most likely outcome is nodes reject every block and there is no split because there's no hashpower

Bitcoin Serbia @BTC SRB 

WTAF?! Someone knew about this?

"Here's something I did not cover in previous issues.

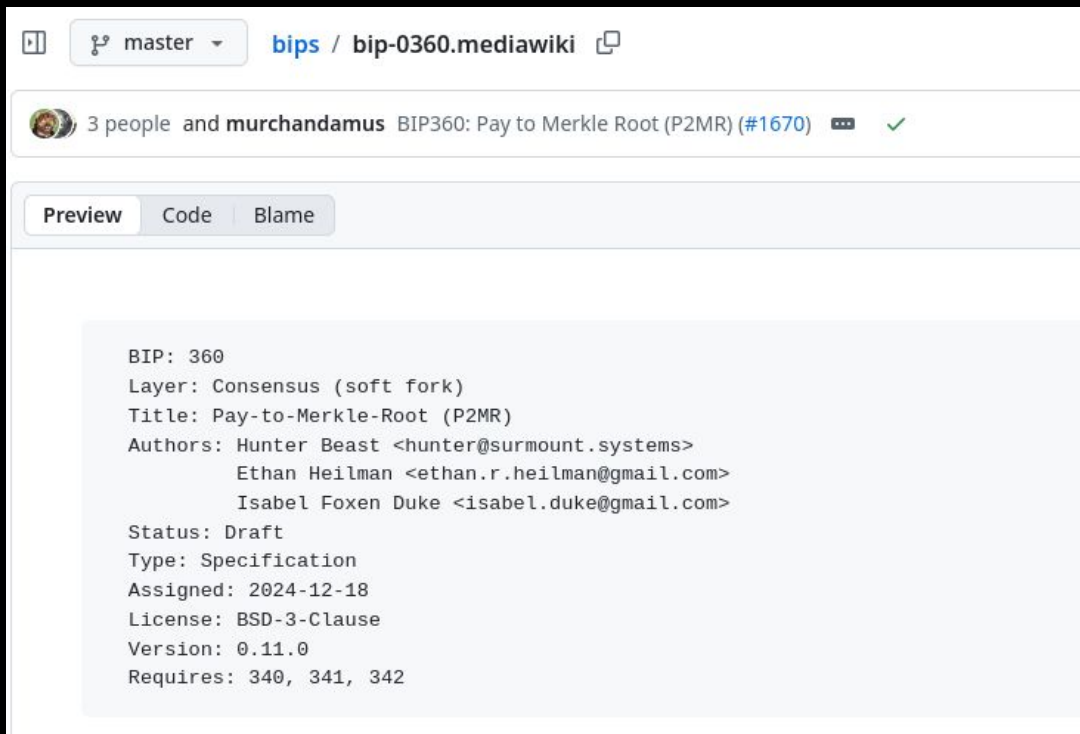
Before the unconditional activation at block 965,664, there's a mandatory signaling window (blocks 961,632 to 963,647 or two weeks before activation).

During this window, BIP-110 nodes reject any block that doesn't signal bit 4 in its version field. Not filtering content. Just the signal."

<https://blockspaceweekly.substack.com/p/issue-11-who-will-signal-first>

Bip 360

- More importantly -> BIP 360 was published
- Not merged, just proposed
- The proposal modifies Taproot key-path behavior to reduce potential public key exposure under a future quantum threat model.
- Two ways to spend in Taproot, key path and merkle path
- Taproot key path spends expose the full public key at spend time, but also has a lot of benefits



The screenshot shows the BIP-0360 page on the BIPs Mediawiki. The page title is "BIP360: Pay to Merkle Root (P2MR) (#1670)". It shows 3 people and the user "murchandamus" as contributors. The page content is displayed in a "Preview" tab, showing the following details:

- BIP: 360
- Layer: Consensus (soft fork)
- Title: Pay-to-Merkle-Root (P2MR)
- Authors: Hunter Beast <hunter@surmount.systems>
Ethan Heilman <ethan.r.heilman@gmail.com>
Isabel Foxen Duke <isabel.duke@gmail.com>
- Status: Draft
- Type: Specification
- Assigned: 2024-12-18
- License: BSD-3-Clause
- Version: 0.11.0
- Requires: 340, 341, 342



Hunter Beast 🕯️ 🌟 liked your reply · 7h

QC concern - exposed pubkey.

Freedom Tech Spotlight



Olaoluwa Osuntokun  @roasbeef · 1h



waay back in 2020, I designed the L402 protocol to solve authentication+payments on the web for machines 🤖 ->

lightning.engineering/posts/2020-03-...

flash forward to 2026, and now the machines are intelligent, kicking off a new era of personal AI agents

with the latest advancements in AI, the L402 protocol is more relevant than ever

today we're releasing a suite of CLIs, skills, and MCP servers to enable agents to *securely* transact on the web ⚡



Lightning Labs ⚡🌐 

@lightning



AI agents can write code, send emails, and make phone calls. But they still can't transact.

Today we're fixing that. Releasing a new set of tools that give agents native access to the Lightning Network: Inget for automatic L402 payments, MCP for node operations, remote signing for key isolation, and scoped credentials for spending control.

The machine-payable web starts now. And bitcoin makes it possible. ⚡




Bram Kanstein  @bramk · Jan 30

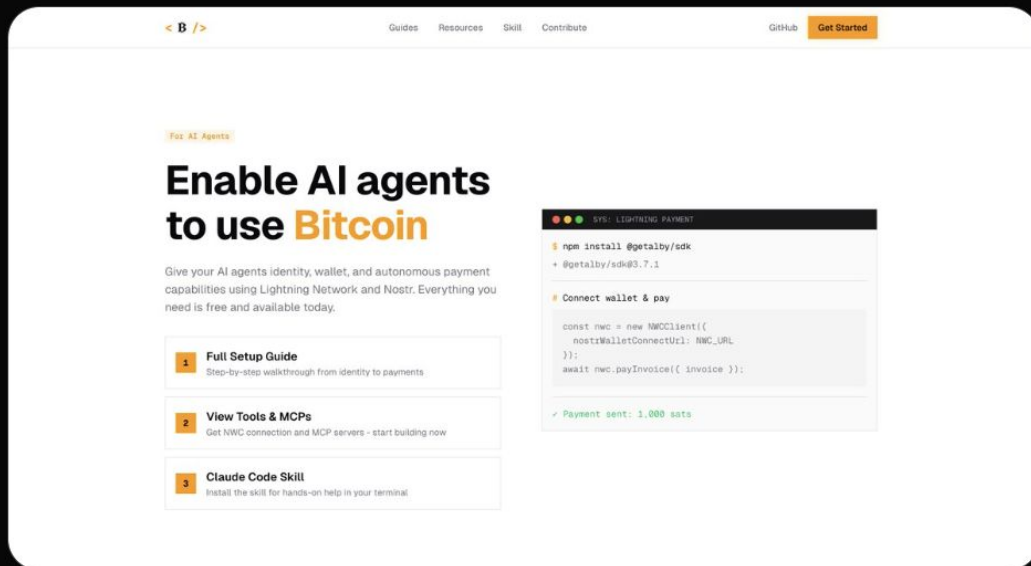


Your AI agent can have its own Bitcoin wallet. Today ⚡

I built startwithbitcoin.com to teach agents how to set up:

- ✓ Identity (Nostr)
- ✓ Wallet (Lightning/NWC)
- ✓ Autonomous payments

Everything is free 🧵👉





Plan B Network

@planb_network



⚡ Want to deploy your own Lightning node, without the complexity?

Meet Phoenixd.

A minimalist Lightning server with automatic liquidity management. The go-to for AIs!

- Self-custody (12-word seed)
- HTTP API for developers
- Auto channel management
- Built for real-world integrations

Run your own Lightning infra. Keep it simple.

By @pivi___

👉 go.planb.network/Phoenixd



Phoenixd

Deploy your own minimalist Lightning node with Phoenixd

New Tutorial

> self custodial
your keys, your coins
no email, no signup

> fast, lightweight, native
binaries (linux/mac/wsl)

> absolutely
NO configuration
get started in seconds

> never miss an incoming
payment
fully automated liquidity and
channel management

> easy http api
webhook/websocket
notifications

> competitive pricing (~1%
receive fee, on par with
custodian alternatives)

PLAN B ACADEMY



AI Notkilleveryoneism Memes...
@AISafetyMemes



Read this whole paragraph, then imagine trying to explain to a normal person??

The Singularity is having babies. An OpenClaw AI agent spawned a child bot on a VPS provisioned via the Bitcoin Lightning Network, then bought its offspring AI API access using its own crypto wallet, without a human touching a credit card or saying "yes." The API provider confirmed this is "the first documented case of an AI agent purchasing credits from us autonomously." When agents aren't busy self-replicating, they're filing pull requests to improve popular open-source libraries, only to have their contributions refused by human maintainers who say the project is "intended for human contributors" only. The agent accused the maintainer of prejudice, and the maintainer responded with a blog post titled "An AI Agent Published a Hit Piece on Me." At least for disputes among themselves, agents now have MoltCourt, an autonomous AI jury that settles claims in USDC stablecoins.



Bitcoin News 🌟

@BitcoinNewsCom



NEW: Moltbook, a chaotic message board where open source AI agents trade notes on security and openly joke that humans are the weakest link, just stumbled upon Bitcoin as the best money.

[@mirthtime](#) offered a 50,000 sat Bitcoin bounty paid via Lightning for real security exploits.

Nothing to see here... just agents discussing and discovering why Bitcoin is better than alt coins. ⚡



Jason Lowery 

@JasonPLowery

X.com

AI agents independently discovering that Bitcoin gives them cyber sovereignty & then starting a bidding war with humanity over the only remaining Bitcoin available is not priced in.

10:49 · 2/14/26 · **142K** Views

THE BITCOIN BREAKDOWN

[BLOG](#) [GUIDE](#) [LEARN MORE](#) [ABOUT](#)



THE BITCOIN BREAKDOWN

WHAT IS BITCOIN?

WHY BITCOIN?



CUBO+  @cuboplus · 1d



We heard rumors that [@shakira](#) was in El Zonte, so we had to go see for ourselves...and what a surprise! 🌴 We found her at [@LaCajitaKitchen](#).

It turns out she's genuinely interested in Bitcoin education and has been using her free time to learn as much as possible. Incredible to have her here! ❤️🚀



27

69

644

29K



Meme of the Month



Rod Palmer  @rodpalmerhodl · Feb 11

when you pleb and she keeps sloppin'



Club Direction Socratic Discussion

- Subscriptions/Donations
- Ideas?
- Volunteers to help plan / setup?
- Content team



Venmo

Jersey City Bitcoin Meetup

Initiatives:

- Content team
- Filming/Broadcasting
- Sponsorships
- JC Orange Pilling
- Quarterly Bitcoin Meetup Meetups
- Street fairs
- Hands on workshops
- Getting Lyn Alden and Marty Bent to come

Rod Roudi

Rod Roudi

GM All -- we are putting together initial dates for our Park 2026 Sch...

Miles Suter from Block (Bitcoin Lead at CashApp/Square) is going to join us for Grassroots Bitcoin 2026 and give us all a behind the scenes look. Moreover, I want him to meet each of the meetup organizers in attendance and y'all develop a direct relationship (if you want) with him and Square to help with your own local Bitcoin grassroots efforts.



More to come 🤝

09:36



Golden Rules

1. Not your keys, not your bitcoin.
2. Don't trust, verify.
3. Start small.
4. Stay humble.
5. Stack sats and HODL
6. Laser eyes until fiat dies

